

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

THURSDAY, JUNE 19, 2025

Iran tells Trump to stay out of war

Messages mixed on possibility of diplomatic talks

By Matthew Mpoke Bigg, Natan Odenheimer, and Michael Levenson
NEW YORK TIMES

Iran's supreme leader defiantly rejected President Trump's demand for an "unconditional surrender" Wednesday, and warned against any American military intervention in Israel's escalating war with Iran, now in its sixth day.

"Intelligent people who know Iran, the nation and the history of Iran, will never speak to this nation in the language of threats, because the Iranian nation cannot be surrendered," the supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, said in a televised statement, according to state media. "The Americans should know that any US military intervention will undoubtedly be accompanied by irreparable damage."

His remarks came a day after Trump raised the possibility of killing Khamenei but said he would not do so, "at least for

MIDEAST, Page A8

In Milton, housing plan finally gets OK

Town was among first to fight state law

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

In a signal that fierce resistance to a controversial state law aimed at easing the region's deep housing shortage may be fading, the town of Milton passed a plan Tuesday night that would make it easier to build multifamily housing in some key stretches of town.

For well over a year, Milton has served as the locus of opposition to the law — Beacon Hill's biggest effort in decades to tackle the state's deep housing shortage — and now joins a growing list of communities that have eventually decided to go along with it.

The vote by Milton Town Meeting comes after a years-long saga that included multiple zoning plans, a heated referendum, and shake-ups of the town's elected boards.

The vote could permit up to 2,461 more homes in the town of 28,000 just south of Boston. With the vote, the town has also removed itself from the

MILTON, Page A12

Trans care ruling affects half of US

But states such as Mass. with no prohibition do not face new limits

By Kay Lazar and Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

and Emily Spatz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The US Supreme Court Wednesday upheld a Tennessee ban on gender-affirming care

for children and adolescents, in a ruling decried as "devastating," "heartbreaking," and "cruel" by advocates for transgender rights.

The 6-3 decision will affect Tennessee and 26 other states that already prohibit medica-

tion or surgical care for transgender youth, effectively protecting those laws.

But across New England where all states but New Hampshire have passed laws protecting access to transgender care, those rights will remain in place, said Jennifer Levi, GLAD Law senior director of transgender and queer rights.

►N.H. legislation is similar to Tennessee law. B1.

"Nothing in this decision prevents care from being provided in states that do not have bans," she said. "So for the half of the country that does not have bans, that care should and will continue to be provided."

Though the country is sharply divided on this issue,

Levi said she doesn't expect this decision to fuel additional state bans regarding transgender care. Nor does the decision address the many contentious issues that remain regarding transgender rights, such as in schools or athletics.

With this decision, the court is putting its stamp on a national political debate that

SUPREME COURT, Page A6



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Read is acquitted on most charges

Sloppy police work hurt case, experts say

By Shelley Murphy, Sean Cotter, and Dan Glaun
GLOBE STAFF

The case against Karen Read was hamstrung by the sloppy and unprofessional police investigation from the start, legal experts say, and prosecutors compounded the issues by aggressively charging Read with murder.

Read, 45, was acquitted Wednesday of charges of second-degree murder, manslaughter by drunk driving, and leaving the scene of a crash resulting in death. She was convicted of a charge of operating under the influence, a misdemeanor. That was the lone charge available to the jury that did not involve them finding that Read struck her boyfriend, Boston Police Officer John O'Keefe, with a car.

The verdict was greeted with an uproarious cheer from hundreds of pink-clad pro-Read demonstrators outside the Dedham courthouse. The trial, which followed a mistrial caused by a hung jury last year, drew major publicity through its allegations that Read was

READ REACTION, Page A9



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Top: Karen Read, with lawyers David Yannetti and Alan Jackson, acknowledged her supporters outside court on Wednesday. Above: Some of those supporters celebrated after the verdict was announced.

'Three and a half years later and I just miss my friend. He was the best guy I ever knew.'

SEAN COYLE, friend of John O'Keefe

Second trial ends with single guilty verdict for drunken driving

By Travis Andersen and Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF
and Ava Berger
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

DEDHAM — As hundreds gathered outside the Dedham courthouse, a jury acquitted Karen Read of killing her boyfriend, Boston Police Officer John O'Keefe, on a wintry night in 2022, ending a years-long criminal case that featured accusations of police misconduct, attracted global attention, and sparked endless theories of what actually transpired in that Canton driveway.

After about three days of deliberations, a jury cleared Read of the three most serious charges brought against her: second-degree murder, manslaughter while operating under the influence, and leaving the scene of a crash resulting in death.

The jury found her guilty only of a lesser charge of drunken driving. She will serve one year of probation as a first-time offender.

Read and her attorneys emerged from the Norfolk Superior Courthouse where they met by throngs of her cheering supporters. Read thanked the pink-clad crowd for backing her "for almost four years."

"And the second thing I want to say is no

READ VERDICT, Page A9



WALDEN POND FACE LIFT STARTS

Swimmers at Walden Pond can enjoy the water but have a much smaller beach area as the state undertakes a \$6.1 million project to modernize the Concord site popular with visitors. The main beach will be closed this summer during construction of a new bathroom and other work. B1.

SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

The State Department said it is restarting the suspended process for foreigners applying for student visas, but all applicants will now be required to unlock their social media accounts for government review. A2.

The Massachusetts Department of Transportation's board awarded a 35-

year redevelopment lease for the state's 18 highway service plazas to Irish retailer Applegreen, with construction set to begin in six months. D1.

Dozens of Nancy Feldman's former players have shown their support for the retired BU soccer coach after she was accused of sexual harassment. C11.

Fan appreciation day

Thursday: Hotter, clouds and sun. High: 88-93. Low: 66-71.

Friday: Sunny, windy, less humid. High: 83-88. Low: 65-70. Sunrise: 5:07 Sunset: 8:24

Comics and Weather, D5-6. Obituaries, C11.

VOL. 307, NO. 170

Suggested retail price \$4.00



0 947725 4